

What is a Function?

A **Function** is a ready-made formula in Excel/Google Sheets.

Think of it like a calculator button.

For example:

- SUM → Add numbers
 - AVERAGE → Find average
 - MAX → Find highest value
 - MIN → Find lowest value
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Demo Table

Enter this in Google Sheets:

Cell	Value
A1	Sales
A2	100
A3	200
A4	300
A5	400
A6	500

It will look like:

A
Sales
100

200

300

400

500

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Cell	Value
A1	Sales
A2	100
A3	200
A4	300
A5	400
A6	500

Method 1: Manual Addition

Suppose you want the total sales.

In cell A8 type:

=A2+A3+A4+A5+A6

What Excel Does

100 + 200 + 300 + 400 + 500

Result:

1500

Problem

Imagine 1000 sales records.

You would need:

=A2+A3+A4+A5+A6+A7+A8+A9+A10...

Very difficult.

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Method 2: Using Function

In cell A9 type:

=SUM(A2:A6)

Result:

1500

Same answer, but much easier.

Understanding the Formula

Formula:

=SUM(A2:A6)

Let's break it into parts.

Part 1: "="

=

Means:

"Excel, I am starting a calculation."

Without "=" Excel treats it as text.

Example:

SUM(A2:A6)

Excel sees only text.

Example:

=SUM(A2:A6)

Excel performs calculation.

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Part 2: SUM

SUM

SUM is the function name.

Meaning:

"Add all numbers together."

Think:

SUM = Addition Machine

Part 3: ()

(A2:A6)

These are called parentheses.

Inside them we tell Excel:

Which cells should be used?

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Part 4: A2:A6

A2:A6

Means:

Cell	Value
A2	100
A3	200
A4	300
A5	400
A6	500

The colon : means:

Start at A2 and continue until A6.

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Visual Explanation

A2:A6

Start	End

Excel reads:

100
200
300
400
500

Then SUM adds them:

100 + 200 + 300 + 400 + 500

Result:

1500

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Real MIS Example

Employee	Sales
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Ravi	10000
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Priya	15000
-------	-------

Kumar	12000
-------	-------

Ajay	18000
------	-------

Stored in:

A	B
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Employee	Sales
----------	-------

Ravi	10000
------	-------

Priya	15000
-------	-------

Kumar	12000
-------	-------

Ajay	18000
------	-------

To calculate total sales:

=SUM(B2:B5)

Excel calculates:

10000 + 15000 + 12000 + 18000

Result:

Quick Revision

Formula:

=SUM(A2:A6)

Part	Meaning
=	Start calculation
SUM	Add numbers
()	Hold the range
A2:A6	From A2 to A6

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B10 =sum(B3:B8)

	A	B	
1	Cell	Value	
2	A1	Sales	
3	A2	100	
4	A3	200	
5	A4	300	
6	A5	400	
7	A6	500	
8	B8	600	
9			
10		2100	
11			

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